

Third User Feedback / Formative Evaluation 3

1 Session overview

Session type: Third formative user feedback

Project stage: Late-stage interactive prototype

Session date: 2026-05-09

Duration: Approximately 20–30 minutes

Participant: 1 user from our intended target group

Method: Guided walkthrough + think-aloud feedback during task exploration

2 Participant profile

The participant was a potential target user of our system and had experience using GitHub repositories and web-based collaboration tools. The participant tested the latest version of the prototype, focusing on repository connection, synchronization, XP rules, goal creation, goal status, and error feedback.

3 Goal of the session

The purpose of this session was to evaluate:

- whether repository connection errors are shown clearly,
- whether synchronization feedback is understandable,
- whether XP rules are easy to understand,
- whether goal creation and draft saving are clear,
- whether goal status is visible and meaningful,
- and whether the interface feels predictable during common actions.

4 Tasks / walkthrough focus

During the session, the participant explored and commented on the following core parts of the system:

- repository URL input,
- recent repositories,
- manual synchronization,
- toast feedback,
- XP rules,
- goal creation,
- goal draft saving,
- goal editing,
- goal status display,
- active goals,
- and clickable interface elements.

5 Main feedback from the participant

The participant felt that the application was easier to understand than before, especially after repository switching and goal management were improved. However, several small interaction details still caused confusion.

The participant mainly noticed that repository errors should not appear under the input field, because this makes users think the repository itself is always wrong. They also felt that XP rules are important but not immediately clear for first-time users. In the goal flow, the word “Save” was unclear, and goal status needed to be more visible.

6 Detailed feedback points

- Repository-related errors should be shown as toast messages instead of red text under the Repository URL input.
- Recent repositories loading errors should not affect manual repository input.
- If the user enters nothing in the repository input, the app should show a toast message instead of marking the field red.
- Success and error toast messages should use different colors.
- Sync API errors should be shown in a user-friendly way.
- The participant saw two similar usernames and asked whether they were the same person. We identified that this comes from GitHub data: if a user changes their GitHub username, GitHub may return them as different identities in historical data, so this is not caused by our app.
- XP rules should have a simpler explanation, because users may not immediately know that they control how GitHub activities are converted into XP.
- The word “Save” in the goal form was unclear. “Save draft” is easier to understand.
- The Create a team goal form should show goal status.
- Goal status should be calculated automatically from the selected time range and progress.
- The goal status field should not be manually editable.
- If a created or updated goal becomes completed or expired, the app should ask the user to confirm.
- For active goals, users should be able to manually mark a goal as completed when the target has already been achieved.
- If there are many active goals, the active goal list should have a maximum height and become scrollable.
- Confusing copy-related actions should be removed.
- Clickable buttons and interactive areas should use a pointer cursor.

7 Observed usability problems

From this session, we identified five main usability issues:

1. Error feedback placement

Some repository errors were shown too close to the input field. This made users think the repository input itself was wrong, even when the issue came from GitHub API or Recent repositories loading.

2. Recent repositories affecting the main flow

Recent repositories is only a helper section, but its loading error could make the manual repository connection flow feel broken.

3. XP rules were not clear enough

The participant did not immediately understand what XP rules mean. Since XP rules affect ranking and progress, the concept needs a short explanation.

4. Goal actions and status needed clearer wording

The participant found “Save” unclear and wanted goal status to be visible in the creation flow.

5. Active goal control could be stronger

The participant expected users to have more control over active goals, such as manually marking an achieved goal as completed.

8 Planned improvements after this feedback

Based on the session, we implemented or plan to implement the following changes:

- Move repository and sync errors into center toast messages.
- Use green toast messages for success and red toast messages for errors.
- Prevent Recent repositories loading errors from affecting manual repository input.
- Add a clear button inside the Repository URL input field.
- Keep GitHub username differences as returned by GitHub, since username history is external data and not controlled by our app.
- Add a simpler explanation for XP rules.
- Rename Save to Save draft in the goal form.
- Add a read-only goal status field in the Create a team goal form.
- Automatically calculate goal status from the selected start and end time.
- Show a confirmation message if a goal becomes completed or expired during creation or editing.
- Add a Complete button for active goals, so users can manually mark them as completed.
- Make long active goal lists scrollable.
- Remove confusing copy-related buttons.
- Add pointer cursor styling to clickable elements.

9 Reflection

This feedback session was useful because it focused on small but important interaction details. The main structure of the app was already understandable, but the participant helped identify issues that could still confuse users during normal use.

Compared with previous evaluations, the repository flow and goal management flow had improved. However, this session showed that error feedback, XP rule explanation, and goal status handling still needed polishing.

The feedback helped us make the final prototype clearer and more predictable. Repository errors are now separated from helper sections like Recent repositories, goal actions use clearer wording, and goal status is treated as an important part of the goal creation and management flow.

10 Screenshots of Adopted Changes

The screenshot displays a web interface with a light gray background. At the top, a red rounded rectangle contains the text "Use owner/repo or a full GitHub repository URL." Below this, a light blue horizontal bar spans the width of the interface. Underneath the bar, on the left, is a blue pill-shaped button labeled "2 saved". To its right, a light gray button with a filter icon and the text "XP rules" is visible. Further right, a section titled "What" is partially shown, containing a green checkmark icon and the text "V". Below these elements, a text input field is labeled "Repository URL" and contains the text "sdasa". To the right of the input field is a small gray circle with a white "x" icon. At the bottom, a dark blue button with the text "Validate and connect" is centered.

Team XP rules ⓘ

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Shared rules for Ch4you/dh2642-github-hero-quest.

Repository

Ch4you/dh2642-github-hero-quest

Commit

5

Merged PR

20

Review

10

Open PR

2

Cancel

Save team XP rules

ACTIONS

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✎

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